The same procedure was followed on an intradepartmental basis also. Heads of various sections would similarly move around together and coordinate the movement of various sections. Parking spaces, parking labels, advertisement space and traffic training literature would all be earmarked (the methodology was devised during the dry runs). She made her first audiovisual presentation of the Asian games traffic management plans before a select group of sponsors, for raising funds for traffic guidance material. This event was unique because this was the first time that such a presentation was done. She was ably assisted by Achal Paul, an advertising professional who then working with Clarion Advertising. The sponsors responded generously by committing themselves to providing a variety of road safety and educational material worth Rs 35 lakh. Prahlad Kakkar, another advertising professional, made a film on road safety entitled *Who Saw the Zebra Crossing?*, which was sponsored by Ramesh Chauhan of Limca and Thums Up, wellknown fizzy soft drinks. The Modis (renowned industrialists) sponsored all the traffic booths, which had traffic helmets as headtops. The Pure Drinks group sponsored traffic islands. MRF (Madras Rubber Factory) provided road dividers and Apollo Tyres sponsored road safety literature. These dry runs and on-the-spot workshops, which were many, enabled her to put the money collected to the best use possible for the benefit of Delhi commuters. Such a bonanza (the availability of creative road safety information literature) had never been seen before. With the budgeted money for such purposes, which the traffic unit saved because of sponsorships, Kiran decided to buy traffic police jeeps for her officers. This was for the first time that four wheelers were being allocated to inspectors in the traffic unit. Kiran was winning not only the admiration of the people at large but also the hearts of her entire staff.

If the sum total of her efforts for the preparation and the actual execution of her traffic plans for the Asian games of 1982 were to be expressed, it could be done so by using only one word – excellent. The most cherished memory of that period was when she was called upon to receive an award called 'Asian Jyoti' for excellence soon after the successful completion of the Asian games. She declined to accept the award for herself alone. She recommended that the entire traffic police unit be awarded so that the award could become a part of the professional record of all those who made such 'excellence' possible. It appears that no one was willing set this precedent. For such magnanimity in leadership is unheard of in the government services.

The result: while the people and the media hailed the traffic management during the Asian games as 'excellent', Kiran drew satisfaction from the fact that she did not take the credit for herself alone.

The *Indian Express*, in its issue of 4 December 1982, reported:

GAMES A GRAND SUCCESS

> … In the end, the greatest triumph was the way the traffic was kept moving during the Games, particularly during the closing ceremony and the opening day (Nov. 19). The police authorities deserve to be complimented.

The bane of Delhi traffic was (and continues to be) wrong and indiscriminate parking and this one factor was (and is) a major cause of traffic snarl-ups. Kiran hit hard here and, after sufficient warnings to the public at large through the loudspeaker fitted to her car, she soon pressed several cranes into action in order to tow away the offending vehicles to the nearest police station. It was not long after this that she earned the sobriquet of 'Crane' Bedi.

Also, she insisted that offending vehicles would no longer be *challaned* but would be 'spot-fined'.